



19 February 2026
Rebecca Economides

Dear Rebecca:

The Nature Conservancy is interested in developing an overview of how weather and climate may influence fire risk in the Northwoods Region due to climate change, with the goal of providing context and direction for future TNC projects. This overview will rely primarily on academic papers/journal articles and conversations with fire managers, experts, and ecologists with familiarity of the Northwoods Region. Included will be a nuanced discussion describing how specific weather and climate changes are projected to play out due to climate change in different parts of the Northwoods Region, with highlights toward changes in fire weather. The end deliverable may also include:

- what "fire weather" means to different groups
- specific projected changes in climate and weather patterns with layered, indirect, interdisciplinary impacts to fire risk
- perspectives from operational fire personnel, fire-specific ecologists, and atmospheric scientists

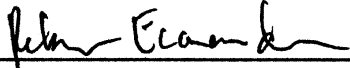
The end deliverable will be in the form of a written summary.

Once delivered, you will be compensated at a rate of \$30 per hour for a maximum of 60 hours (total not to exceed \$1,800) based on an invoice that documents hours worked on the project and specifying deliveries. The period of work will be no longer than 16 February – 31 May 2026.

Kim Hall (kimberly.hall@tnc.org) and Randy Swaty (rsваты@tnc.org) will be your points of contact for the tasks identified in the agreement.

If you agree with these terms, please sign below, scan and email the signed letter to jim_smith@tnc.org for TNC signature. He will return a signed copy to you for your records.

Sincerely,


Rebecca Economides

2/23/2026
Date


James L. Smith

2/25/2026
Date